



Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

UEN: 201200696W

LEARNER GUIDE

For

Wireshark Network Analysis Masterclass

Course Code: C1123

Conducted by

Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

UEN: 201200696W

Version 5.1

DOCUMENT VERSION CONTROL RECORD

Version Number	Effective Date of Release	Summary of Included Changes	Author
4.0	2 October 2026	Revised from the supplied v3 deck; current guidance, visuals and 18 self-contained labs.	Dr. Alfred Ang
5.0	5 October 2026	Deck rebuilt on the house non-WSQ engine (C735 design system): full admin opener, core-concepts section, reference diagrams re-presented as captioned visuals, TShark evidence visuals per lab, per-topic schedule with day dividers and breaks.	Dr. Alfred Ang
5.1	5 October 2026	Lab step slides replaced by scenario + summary slides (full steps in the LG and new per-lab instruction MD/PDF). About 40 new concept slides with visuals drawn from the lab captures; DHCP, NAT, IPv6, TShark, security patterns and baselining added from external sources. Per-lab scenario tickets, findings templates, TShark equivalents and optional extensions.	Dr. Alfred Ang

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Introduction.....	5
Course Learning Outcomes.....	5
Before You Start — Preparation.....	5
Topic 01 — Introduction to Network Analysis and Wireshark.....	6
Lab 1 — Establish a trace baseline.....	6
Topic 02 — Capture Methods and Capture Filters.....	8
Lab 2 — Plan capture placement.....	9
Topic 03 — Global Preferences and Troubleshooting Profiles.....	11
Lab 3 — Create an analyst profile.....	11
Topic 04 — Navigation and Coloring Techniques.....	13
Lab 4 — Color and annotate evidence.....	14
Topic 05 — Time Values and Delay Types.....	15
Lab 5 — Separate path and server delay.....	16
Topic 06 — Trace Statistics and VoIP Overview.....	18
Lab 6 — Summarize traffic and a voice stream.....	18
Topic 07 — Display Filters.....	20
Lab 7 — Build a filter evidence matrix.....	20
Topic 08 — TCP/IP Communications and Resolution.....	22
Lab 8 — Reconstruct an application dependency chain.....	23
Topic 09 — DNS Traffic Analysis.....	25
Lab 9 — Diagnose DNS failure and delay.....	25
Topic 10 — ARP Traffic Analysis.....	27
Lab 10 — Verify link-local resolution.....	27
Topic 11 — IPv4 Traffic Analysis.....	29
Lab 11 — Classify IPv4 scope and headers.....	29
Topic 12 — ICMP Traffic Analysis.....	31
Lab 12 — Interpret echo and unreachable messages.....	31
Topic 13 — UDP Traffic Analysis.....	33
Lab 13 — Follow datagrams and service refusal.....	33
Topic 14 — TCP Protocol Analysis.....	35
Lab 14 — Investigate retransmission and zero window.....	36
Topic 15 — Traffic Graphs.....	38
Lab 15 — Graph bytes, RTT and recovery.....	38
Topic 16 — HTTP and HTTP/2 Analysis.....	40
Lab 16 — Inspect HTTP outcomes and HTTP/2 frames.....	41
Topic 17 — TLS-Encrypted Traffic Analysis.....	42

Lab 17 — Compare encrypted and decrypted views.....	43
Topic 18 — Ten Troubleshooting Steps and Reporting.....	45
Lab 18 — Produce an evidence-led incident report.....	46
Next Steps.....	48
Further Learning.....	48
Glossary.....	48

Introduction

This guide supports C1123, a four-day, 30-hour commercial short course. It includes detailed instructions for 18 self-contained labs using supplied synthetic packet captures.

Version 5.0 aligns the slides, this guide and the lesson plan with the Tertiary Infotech house design. Every lab ships with its own synthetic capture, templates and verification script; the Expected Evidence figure in each lab shows the packet list you should reproduce.

Course Learning Outcomes

- LO1: Plan scoped captures and configure a reproducible analyst profile.
- LO2: Navigate, filter, summarize and time network exchanges.
- LO3: Interpret DNS, ARP, IPv4, ICMP and UDP evidence.
- LO4: Diagnose TCP and application behaviour, including HTTP and authorised TLS inspection.
- LO5: Report observed facts, hypotheses and next actions with defensible evidence.

Before You Start — Preparation

What you need

- Windows or macOS laptop; Wireshark 4.6 or later from <https://www.wireshark.org/download.html>.
- TShark CLI tools for automated fixture checks; Python 3 for scripts. Scapy and OpenSSL only if regenerating data.
- Download the whole labs folder so captures, templates and scripts stay together.

Verify your setup

Confirm Wireshark opens branch-office.pcap. For command-line checks use:

```
tshark --version  
python3 --version
```

Conventions used in every lab

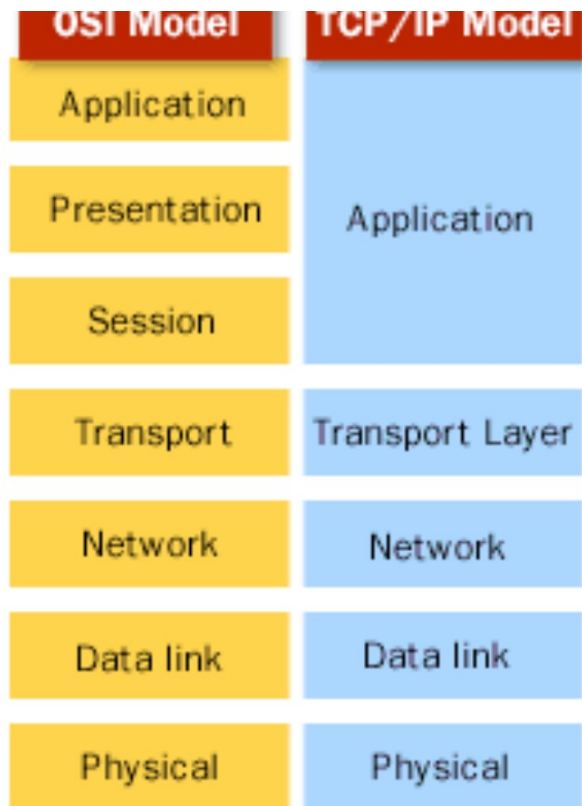
- Windows: use `py -3` instead of `python3`. If `tshark` is not on `PATH`, use the Wireshark installation directory.
- All packet addresses and names are synthetic. The generator sends no packets.
- Steps assume you are inside the current lab folder. Clear filters between investigations.
- 4 days include 450 instructional minutes and 30 minutes of tea breaks each day; lunch is separate.

Topic 01 — Introduction to Network Analysis and Wireshark

Establish a trace baseline

Key concepts

- A capture is a measurement at one observation point, not a complete network history.
- Packet list, protocol details and bytes connect a summary to the underlying evidence.
- Record interface, timestamp precision, dropped packets and capture scope before interpreting a trace.



The TCP/IP and OSI Models — OSI layers mapped to the TCP/IP model

Lab 1 — Establish a trace baseline

Learning outcome: LO1.

Goal: A capture is a measurement at one observation point, not a complete network history.

What you'll build

Evidence CSV and packet findings (Tools: Wireshark, TShark, Python.)

Step-by-step

1. Prepare your lab workspace. Open this lab folder in a terminal. Windows uses `py -3` in place of `python3`. Wireshark GUI alone is sufficient for the investigation; CLI scripts require TShark on PATH. Run the fixture verification first.

```
python3 scripts/verify.py
```

2. Open `data/branch-office.pcap` with `File > Open`. Clear the display filter. Record the packet count from the status bar and the capture duration from `Statistics > Capture File Properties`.
3. Select frame 1. Expand Ethernet II and Address Resolution Protocol in Packet Details. Click the sender IP field and observe the corresponding bytes.
4. Apply `arp` in the display filter toolbar. Compare request and reply sender/target IP and MAC addresses. Save the two frame numbers in `outputs/findings.md`.
5. Export a reproducible packet table. Record the filter, frame numbers, measurement, explanation and limitation in `outputs/findings.md`.

```
python3 scripts/export_evidence.py
```

Test it

The supplied `arp` expression matches 2 frame(s) in the specified capture. Run `scripts/verify.py` and compare the listed frame numbers. Keep your findings and exported table in `outputs/`. Explain the observed result rather than only copying a count.

arp					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
1	0.000000	02:00:00:00:00:10	ff:ff:ff:ff:ff:ff	ARP	Who has 192.0.2.20? Tell 192.0.2.10
2	0.010000	02:00:00:00:00:20	02:00:00:00:00:10	ARP	192.0.2.20 is at 02:00:00:00:00:20
branch-office.pcap Displayed: 2					

Lab 1 expected evidence — the packet list your filter should produce

Troubleshooting

TShark not found: install Wireshark CLI tools and add the installation folder to PATH; on Windows use the Wireshark install directory. A filter returns zero: clear other filters, use the specified capture, and check the expression is in the display toolbar. TLS remains opaque: select the matching `lab-tls.keys` file by absolute path, reload, and remove a key-log preference from another lab.

Try it with TShark

```
tshark -n -r data/branch-office.pcap -Y arp
```

Challenge

Develop and explain an alternative filter.

Reflection

Which second observation point would strengthen your conclusion?

Extension (optional)

Getting Started lab — capture your own short baseline on an authorised network and compare its protocol mix with this file. Source: J.F. Kurose and K.W. Ross, Wireshark Labs (gaia.cs.umass.edu/kurose_ross/wireshark.php).

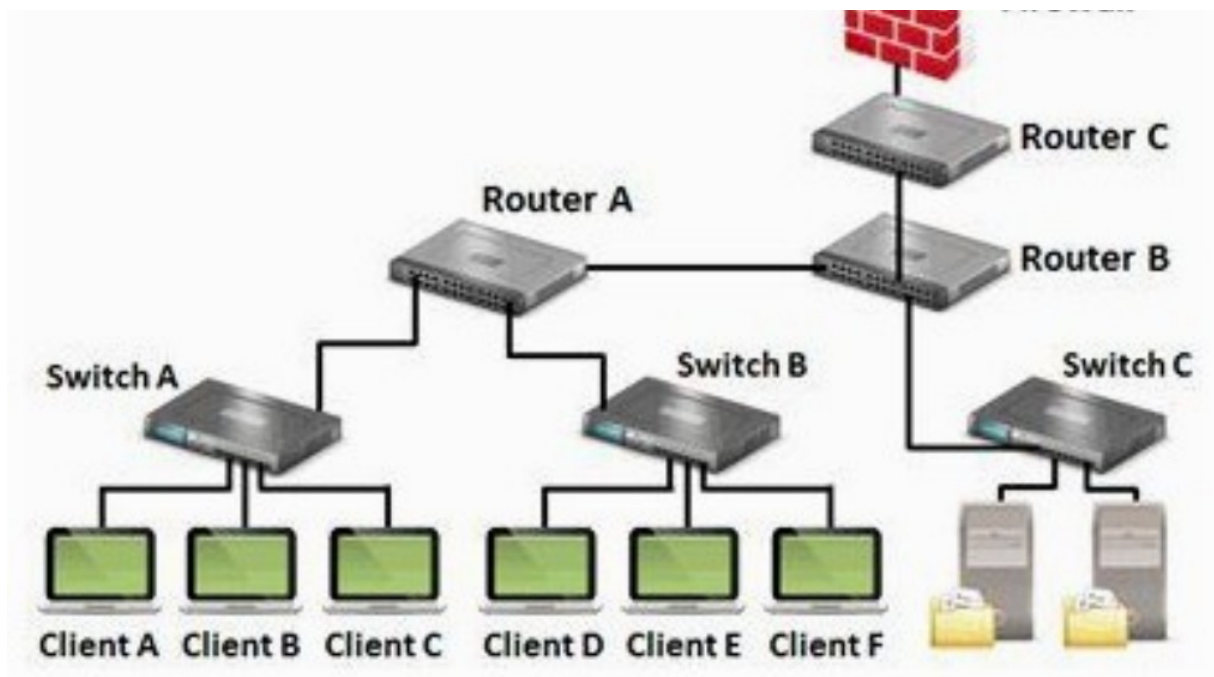
Note: Printable copy: [labs/lab-01-establish-a-trace-baseline/LAB-01-Instructions.pdf](#). Use the README in the matching [labs/lab-NN-title/](#) folder. Capture only with permission.

Topic 02 — Capture Methods and Capture Filters

Plan capture placement

Key concepts

- A switched access port normally observes its own traffic and broadcasts; SPAN or TAP placement changes visibility.
- Capture filters use libpcap syntax before packets are stored; display filters hide or show stored packets.
- Bound file size and duration; check capture drops before attributing missing packets to network loss.



Where to Tap Into the Network — Choose the observation point before you capture

Lab 2 — Plan capture placement

Learning outcome: LO1.

Goal: A switched access port normally observes its own traffic and broadcasts; SPAN or TAP placement changes visibility.

What you'll build

Evidence CSV and packet findings (Tools: Wireshark, TShark, Python.)

Step-by-step

1. Prepare your lab workspace. Open this lab folder in a terminal. Windows uses `py -3` in place of `python3`. Wireshark GUI alone is sufficient for the investigation; CLI scripts require TShark on PATH. Run the fixture verification first.

```
python3 scripts/verify.py
```

2. Open `assets/topology.md`. Draw a sensor on the client access port, on a mirrored uplink and beside the server. State which traffic each sees.
3. Open Capture > Options and inspect the interface list without starting a capture. Enter `tcp port 80` in the capture-filter box and check syntax feedback. Cancel the dialog.
4. Open `data/branch-office.pcap`. Enter `tcp.port == 80` in the DISPLAY toolbar. Compare the stored total with the displayed total; explain why clearing it restores hidden packets.
5. Complete `assets/capture-plan.md` with scope, interface, duration, ring-buffer limit and permission owner. Wireless monitor mode requires compatible adapter/driver; USB capture requires platform-specific support. Remote capture should use authorised SSH/extcap, not obsolete unauthenticated RPC instructions.
6. Export a reproducible packet table. Record the filter, frame numbers, measurement, explanation and limitation in `outputs/findings.md`.

```
python3 scripts/export_evidence.py
```

Test it

The supplied `tcp.port == 80` expression matches 37 frame(s) in the specified capture. Run `scripts/verify.py` and compare the listed frame numbers. Keep your findings and exported table in `outputs/`. Explain the observed result rather than only copying a count.

tcp.port == 80					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
18	1.040000	192.0.2.10	192.0.2.20	TCP	51001 → 80 [SYN] Seq=0 Win=64240 Len=0 MSS=1460 W...
19	1.070000	192.0.2.20	192.0.2.10	TCP	80 → 51001 [SYN, ACK] Seq=0 Ack=1 Win=64240 Len=0...
20	1.080000	192.0.2.10	192.0.2.20	TCP	51001 → 80 [ACK] Seq=1 Ack=1 Win=1048576 Len=0
21	1.090000	192.0.2.10	192.0.2.20	HTTP	GET /health HTTP/1.1
22	1.100000	192.0.2.20	192.0.2.10	TCP	80 → 51001 [ACK] Seq=1 Ack=71 Win=1048576 Len=0
23	1.140000	192.0.2.20	192.0.2.10	HTTP	HTTP/1.1 200 OK (text/plain)
24	1.150000	192.0.2.10	192.0.2.20	TCP	51001 → 80 [ACK] Seq=71 Ack=71 Win=8222720 Len=0
25	1.160000	192.0.2.20	192.0.2.10	TCP	80 → 51001 [FIN, ACK] Seq=71 Ack=71 Win=1048576 L...
26	1.170000	192.0.2.10	192.0.2.20	TCP	51001 → 80 [ACK] Seq=71 Ack=72 Win=1048576 Len=0
27	1.180000	192.0.2.10	192.0.2.20	TCP	51002 → 80 [SYN] Seq=0 Win=64240 Len=0 MSS=1460 W...
... 27 more matching packets					
branch-office.pcap Displayed: 37					

Lab 2 expected evidence — the packet list your filter should produce

Troubleshooting

TShark not found: install Wireshark CLI tools and add the installation folder to PATH; on Windows use the Wireshark install directory. A filter returns zero: clear other filters, use the specified capture, and check the expression is in the display toolbar. TLS remains opaque: select the matching lab-tls.keys file by absolute path, reload, and remove a key-log preference from another lab.

Try it with TShark

```
tshark -D
```

Challenge

Develop and explain an alternative filter.

Reflection

Which second observation point would strengthen your conclusion?

Extension (optional)

Getting Started lab — list your interfaces and identify which one carries traffic before planning a capture. Source: J.F. Kurose and K.W. Ross, Wireshark Labs (gaia.cs.umass.edu/kurose_ross/wireshark.php).

Note: Printable copy: [labs/lab-02-plan-capture-placement/LAB-02-Instructions.pdf](#). Use the README in the matching [labs/lab-NN-title/](#) folder. Capture only with permission.

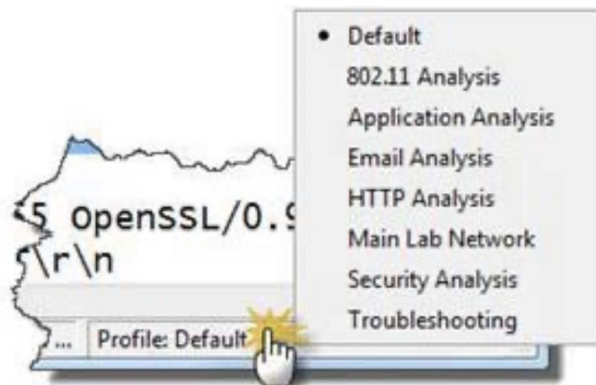
Topic 03 — Global Preferences and Troubleshooting Profiles

Create an analyst profile

Key concepts

- A profile bundles reproducible columns, coloring rules and protocol settings.
- Name resolution can obscure numeric evidence and generate additional traffic; document the setting.
- Protocol heuristics and TCP analysis preferences change interpretation, not the stored bytes.

Right click on the Profile area in the Status bar or select Edit | Configuration Profiles | New to create a new profile.



Configuration Profiles — Right-click the Profile area in the status bar to switch or create

Lab 3 — Create an analyst profile

Learning outcome: LO1.

Goal: A profile bundles reproducible columns, coloring rules and protocol settings.

What you'll build

Evidence CSV and packet findings (Tools: Wireshark, TShark, Python.)

Step-by-step

1. Prepare your lab workspace. Open this lab folder in a terminal. Windows uses `py -3` in place of `python3`. Wireshark GUI alone is sufficient for the investigation; CLI scripts require TShark on PATH. Run the fixture verification first.

```
python3 scripts/verify.py
```

2. Create a profile named C1123-Analyst using Edit > Configuration Profiles. Keep the original profile available.

3. Open data/branch-office.pcap. Disable network name resolution in View > Name Resolution. Record numeric client, server and resolver IP addresses.
4. Select a TCP packet. Expand TCP and right-click Stream index > Apply as Column. Add frame.time_delta_displayed as a custom column using Preferences > Appearance > Columns.
5. Apply dns and inspect the profile name and displayed columns. Copy the profile folder path from Help > About Wireshark > Folders into outputs/findings.md. Export or copy your profile to outputs/profile/ without overwriting a colleague profile.
6. Export a reproducible packet table. Record the filter, frame numbers, measurement, explanation and limitation in outputs/findings.md.

```
python3 scripts/export_evidence.py
```

Test it

The supplied dns expression matches 6 frame(s) in the specified capture. Run scripts/verify.py and compare the listed frame numbers. Keep your findings and exported table in outputs/. Explain the observed result rather than only copying a count.

dns					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
3	0.020000	192.0.2.10	192.0.2.53	DNS	Standard query 0x0065 A portal.example.test
4	0.040000	192.0.2.53	192.0.2.10	DNS	Standard query response 0x0065 A portal.example.t...
5	0.050000	192.0.2.10	192.0.2.53	DNS	Standard query 0x0066 A missing.example.test
6	0.070000	192.0.2.53	192.0.2.10	DNS	Standard query response 0x0066 No such name A mis...
7	0.080000	192.0.2.10	192.0.2.53	DNS	Standard query 0x0067 A slow.example.test
8	0.880000	192.0.2.53	192.0.2.10	DNS	Standard query response 0x0067 A slow.example.tes...
branch-office.pcap Displayed: 6					

Lab 3 expected evidence — the packet list your filter should produce

Troubleshooting

TShark not found: install Wireshark CLI tools and add the installation folder to PATH; on Windows use the Wireshark install directory. A filter returns zero: clear other filters, use the specified capture, and check the expression is in the display toolbar. TLS remains opaque: select the matching lab-tls.keys file by absolute path, reload, and remove a key-log preference from another lab.

Try it with TShark

```
tshark -n -r data/branch-office.pcap -Y dns -T fields -e frame.number -e ip.src -e ip.dst -e dns.qry.name
```

Challenge

Develop and explain an alternative filter.

Reflection

Which second observation point would strengthen your conclusion?

Extension (optional)

Export your C1123-Analyst profile folder and import it on a second machine; confirm the columns appear.

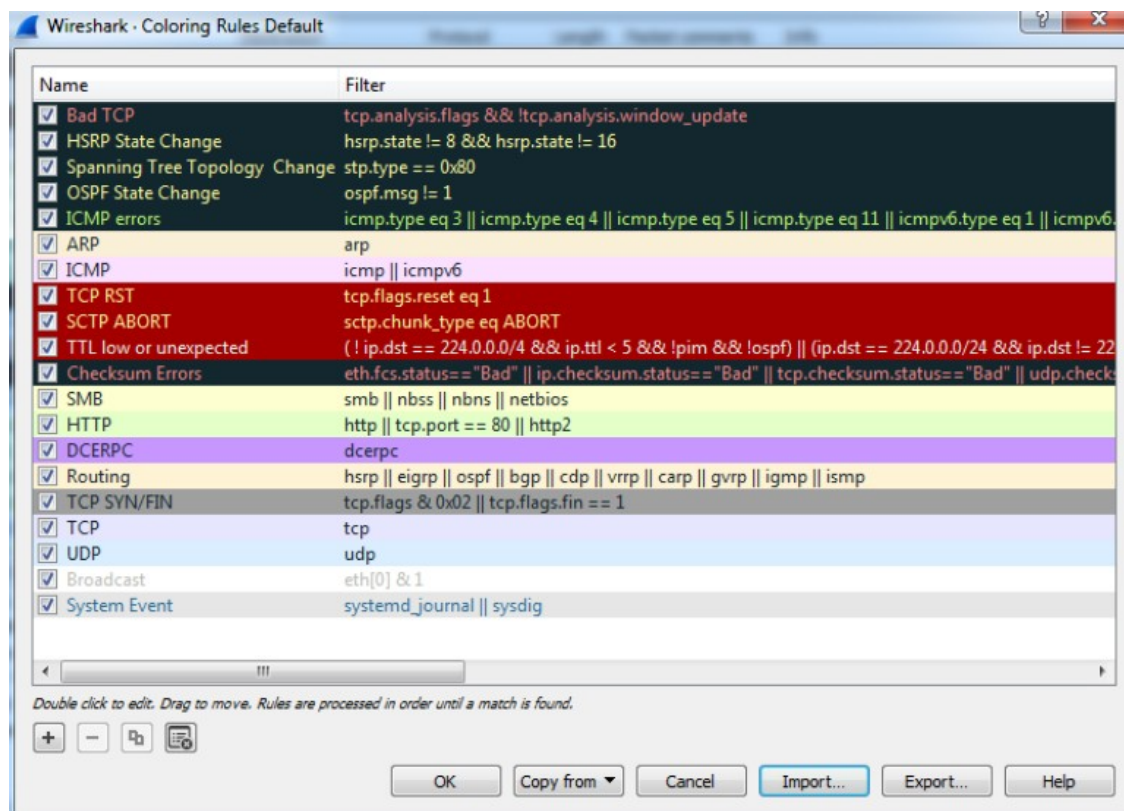
Note: Printable copy: labs/lab-03-create-an-analyst-profile/LAB-03-Instructions.pdf. Use the README in the matching labs/lab-NN-title/ folder. Capture only with permission.

Topic 04 — Navigation and Coloring Techniques

Color and annotate evidence

Key concepts

- Color rules are applied in order; the first matching rule wins.
- Temporary coloring is useful for a conversation; permanent rules support repeated triage.
- Bookmarks and comments preserve the analyst path without changing the captured payload.



Colouring Rules — The coloring rules list is processed in order

Lab 4 — Color and annotate evidence

Learning outcome: LO1.

Goal: Color rules are applied in order; the first matching rule wins.

What you'll build

Evidence CSV and packet findings (Tools: Wireshark, TShark, Python.)

Step-by-step

1. Prepare your lab workspace. Open this lab folder in a terminal. Windows uses `py -3` in place of `python3`. Wireshark GUI alone is sufficient for the investigation; CLI scripts require TShark on PATH. Run the fixture verification first.

```
python3 scripts/verify.py
```

2. Open `data/branch-office.pcap`. Apply `http.response.code >= 400`. Record the 404 and 500 frame numbers.
3. Open View > Coloring Rules. Add LAB HTTP Error with expression `http.response.code >= 400`, dark text and a pale amber background. Move it above a general HTTP rule.
4. Select the 500 response, mark it using Edit > Mark/Unmark Packet and add a packet comment describing the observed status only. Save As `outputs/annotated.pcapng` to preserve comments.
5. Clear the filter. Use Edit > Find Packet with Display filter `http.response.code == 500`. Reopen the saved `pcapng` and confirm the comment persists.
6. Export a reproducible packet table. Record the filter, frame numbers, measurement, explanation and limitation in `outputs/findings.md`.

```
python3 scripts/export_evidence.py
```

Test it

The supplied `http.response.code >= 400` expression matches 2 frame(s) in the specified capture. Run `scripts/verify.py` and compare the listed frame numbers. Keep your findings and exported table in `outputs/`. Explain the observed result rather than only copying a count.

http.response.code >= 400					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
41	2.130000	192.0.2.20	192.0.2.10	HTTP	HTTP/1.1 404 Not Found (text/plain)
50	2.270000	192.0.2.20	192.0.2.10	HTTP	HTTP/1.1 500 Internal Server Error (text/plain)
branch-office.pcap		Displayed: 2			

Lab 4 expected evidence — the packet list your filter should produce

Troubleshooting

TShark not found: install Wireshark CLI tools and add the installation folder to PATH; on Windows use the Wireshark install directory. A filter returns zero: clear other filters, use the specified capture, and check the expression is in the display toolbar. TLS remains opaque: select the matching lab-tls.keys file by absolute path, reload, and remove a key-log preference from another lab.

Try it with TShark

```
tshark -n -r data/branch-office.pcap -Y "http.response.code >= 400" -T fields -e frame.number -e http.response.code -e http.request_in -e http.time
```

Challenge

Develop and explain an alternative filter.

Reflection

Which second observation point would strengthen your conclusion?

Extension (optional)

HTTP lab — apply your LAB HTTP Error rule to the HTTP trace from the Kurose & Ross labs. Source: J.F. Kurose and K.W. Ross, Wireshark Labs (gaia.cs.umass.edu/kurose_ross/wireshark.php).

Note: Printable copy: [labs/lab-04-color-and-annotate-evidence/LAB-04-Instructions.pdf](#). Use the README in the matching [labs/lab-NN-title/](#) folder. Capture only with permission.

Topic 05 — Time Values and Delay Types

Separate path and server delay

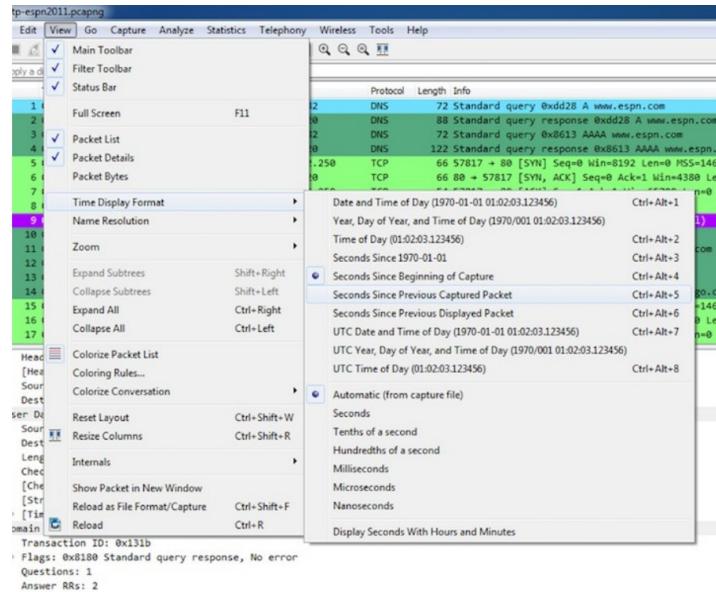
Key concepts

- Displayed delta depends on the current filter; capture delta does not.
- SYN to SYN/ACK gives an initial path-related sample; request to response includes application processing.
- One-sided timestamps cannot identify exactly which intermediate device delayed or dropped a packet.

seconds microseconds

32.130943090

milliseconds nanoseconds



Time Display Formats — Precision depends on the capture hardware and file format

Lab 5 — Separate path and server delay

Learning outcome: LO2.

Goal: Displayed delta depends on the current filter; capture delta does not.

What you'll build

Evidence CSV and packet findings (Tools: Wireshark, TShark, Python.)

Step-by-step

1. Prepare your lab workspace. Open this lab folder in a terminal. Windows uses `py -3` in place of `python3`. Wireshark GUI alone is sufficient for the investigation; CLI scripts require TShark on PATH. Run the fixture verification first.

```
python3 scripts/verify.py
```

2. Open `data/branch-office.pcap`. Apply `tcp.stream == 1`. Expand TCP in the final handshake ACK and inspect `tcp.analysis.initial_rtt`: 0.040 seconds. Separately measure SYN to SYN/ACK by setting a time reference on the SYN: 0.030 seconds.
3. Locate GET `/slow` and its HTTP response. Set a new time reference on the request. Record the response delta: 0.760 seconds, including 0.010 seconds to the server ACK and 0.750 seconds thereafter.
4. Apply `http.request.uri == "/slow" || http.response.code == 200` and compare `frame.time_delta` with `frame.time_delta_displayed` on the filtered list. Explain why a displayed gap can span hidden packets.
5. Write a hypothesis in `outputs/findings.md`: slow response with a synthetic 30 ms SYN-to-SYN/ACK interval and 40 ms complete handshake. Name a second observation point required to distinguish processing from a later path delay.

6. Export a reproducible packet table. Record the filter, frame numbers, measurement, explanation and limitation in outputs/findings.md.

```
python3 scripts/export_evidence.py
```

Test it

The supplied `http.request.uri == "/slow" || http.response.code == 200` expression matches 3 frame(s) in the specified capture. Run `scripts/verify.py` and compare the listed frame numbers. Keep your findings and exported table in `outputs/`. Explain the observed result rather than only copying a count.

http.request.uri == "/slow" http.response.code == 200					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
23	1.140000	192.0.2.20	192.0.2.10	HTTP	HTTP/1.1 200 OK (text/plain)
30	1.230000	192.0.2.10	192.0.2.20	HTTP	GET /slow HTTP/1.1
32	1.990000	192.0.2.20	192.0.2.10	HTTP	HTTP/1.1 200 OK (text/plain)
branch-office.pcap Displayed: 3					

Lab 5 expected evidence — the packet list your filter should produce

Troubleshooting

TShark not found: install Wireshark CLI tools and add the installation folder to PATH; on Windows use the Wireshark install directory. A filter returns zero: clear other filters, use the specified capture, and check the expression is in the display toolbar. TLS remains opaque: select the matching `lab-tls.keys` file by absolute path, reload, and remove a key-log preference from another lab.

Try it with TShark

```
tshark -n -r data/branch-office.pcap -Y "tcp.stream == 1 && http.time"
-T fields -e frame.number -e tcp.analysis.initial_rtt -e http.time
```

Challenge

Develop and explain an alternative filter.

Reflection

Which second observation point would strengthen your conclusion?

Extension (optional)

TCP lab — measure the initial RTT and response times in the TCP trace supplied with the Kurose & Ross labs. Source: J.F. Kurose and K.W. Ross, Wireshark Labs (gaia.cs.umass.edu/kurose_ross/wireshark.php).

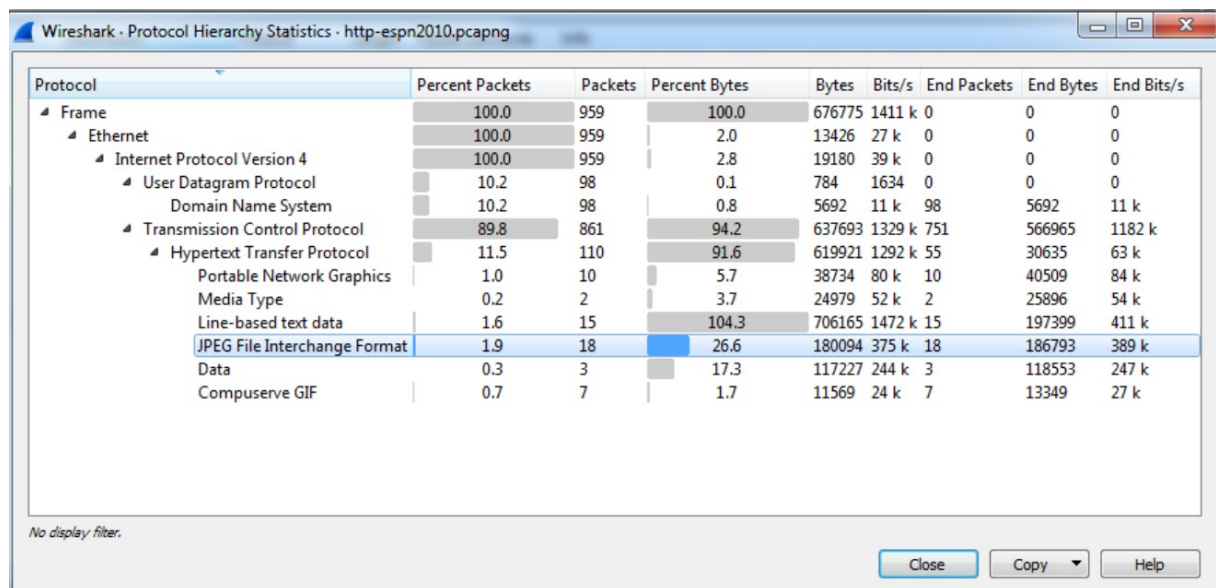
Note: Printable copy: [labs/lab-05-separate-path-and-server-delay/LAB-05-Instructions.pdf](#). Use the README in the matching `labs/lab-NN-title/` folder. Capture only with permission.

Topic 06 — Trace Statistics and VoIP Overview

Summarize traffic and a voice stream

Key concepts

- Protocol Hierarchy shows captured composition; byte share differs from packet share.
- Conversations and Endpoints identify concentration; they do not alone prove malicious activity.
- SIP signals a call while RTP carries media; jitter, loss and codec interpretation need stream context.



Wireshark - Protocol Hierarchy Statistics - http-esp2010.pcapng

Protocol	Percent Packets	Packets	Percent Bytes	Bytes	Bits/s	End Packets	End Bytes	End Bits/s
Frame	100.0	959	100.0	676775	1411 k	0	0	0
Ethernet	100.0	959	2.0	13426	27 k	0	0	0
Internet Protocol Version 4	100.0	959	2.8	19180	39 k	0	0	0
User Datagram Protocol	10.2	98	0.1	784	1634	0	0	0
Domain Name System	10.2	98	0.8	5692	11 k	98	5692	11 k
Transmission Control Protocol	89.8	861	94.2	637693	1329 k	751	566965	1182 k
Hypertext Transfer Protocol	11.5	110	91.6	619921	1292 k	55	30635	63 k
Portable Network Graphics	1.0	10	5.7	38734	80 k	10	40509	84 k
Media Type	0.2	2	3.7	24979	52 k	2	25896	54 k
Line-based text data	1.6	15	104.3	706165	1472 k	15	197399	411 k
JPEG File Interchange Format	1.9	18	26.6	180094	375 k	18	186793	389 k
Data	0.3	3	17.3	117227	244 k	3	118553	247 k
CompuServe GIF	0.7	7	1.7	11569	24 k	7	13349	27 k

No display filter.

Close Copy Help

Capture File Properties — Statistics | Protocol Hierarchy shows the protocol mix

Lab 6 — Summarize traffic and a voice stream

Learning outcome: LO2.

Goal: Protocol Hierarchy shows captured composition; byte share differs from packet share.

What you'll build

Evidence CSV and packet findings (Tools: Wireshark, TShark, Python.)

Step-by-step

1. Prepare your lab workspace. Open this lab folder in a terminal. Windows uses py -3 in place of python3. Wireshark GUI alone is sufficient for the investigation; CLI scripts require TShark on PATH. Run the fixture verification first.

```
python3 scripts/verify.py
```

2. Open data/branch-office.pcap. Open Statistics > Protocol Hierarchy, then Statistics > Conversations. Sort TCP conversations by bytes; save the largest conversation details.
3. Open Statistics > I/O Graphs. Create an all-traffic graph with a 1 second interval and Bits as the unit. Record peak interval and explain the difference between observed bits and usable application throughput.
4. Apply sip and open Telephony > VoIP Calls or SIP Flows. Identify the INVITE and 200 OK. This minimal synthetic exchange is signalling evidence, not a complete production call.
5. Apply udp.port == 4002. Use Analyze > Decode As to decode this UDP port as RTP. Open Telephony > RTP > RTP Streams, select the stream and Analyze. Record sequence numbers 100, 101, 103, 104; the missing sequence is 102.
6. Export a reproducible packet table. Record the filter, frame numbers, measurement, explanation and limitation in outputs/findings.md.

```
python3 scripts/export_evidence.py
```

Test it

The supplied sip expression matches 2 frame(s) in the specified capture. Run scripts/verify.py and compare the listed frame numbers. Keep your findings and exported table in outputs/. Explain the observed result rather than only copying a count.

sip					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
57	3.330000	192.0.2.10	192.0.2.20	SIP	Request: INVITE sip:desk@192.0.2.20
58	3.340000	192.0.2.20	192.0.2.10	SIP	Status: 200 OK (INVITE)
branch-office.pcap Displayed: 2					

Lab 6 expected evidence — the packet list your filter should produce

Troubleshooting

TShark not found: install Wireshark CLI tools and add the installation folder to PATH; on Windows use the Wireshark install directory. A filter returns zero: clear other filters, use the specified capture, and check the expression is in the display toolbar. TLS remains opaque: select the matching lab-tls.keys file by absolute path, reload, and remove a key-log preference from another lab.

Try it with TShark

```
tshark -n -r data/branch-office.pcap -q -z io,phs
```

Challenge

Develop and explain an alternative filter.

Reflection

Which second observation point would strengthen your conclusion?

Extension (optional)

Analyse a longer SIP/RTP call from the Wireshark sample captures (wiki.wireshark.org/SampleCaptures) with Telephony > VoIP Calls.

Note: Printable copy: [labs/lab-06-summarize-traffic-and-a-voice-stream/LAB-06-Instructions.pdf](#). Use the README in the matching [labs/lab-NN-title/](#) folder. Capture only with permission.

Topic 07 — Display Filters

Build a filter evidence matrix

Key concepts

- Parentheses make mixed and/or expressions explicit.
- Field existence and Boolean equality differ: `tcp.flags.syn == 1` tests the bit.
- Since Wireshark 3.6, `!=` uses all-not-equal semantics; historical slides describing any-not-equal are obsolete.

Shortcut	C-Like	Description	Example
eq	==	Equal	<code>Ip.src == 10.1.1.5</code>
ne	!=	Not equal	<code>Ip.src != 10.1.1.5</code>
gt	>	Greater than	<code>Frame.len > 64</code>
lt	<	Less Than	<code>Frame.len < 1518</code>
ge	>=	Greater then or equal to	<code>Frame.len ge 0x100</code>
le	<=	Less then or equal to	<code>Frame.len <= 0x20</code>

Display Filter Operators — Comparison operators with C-like and English forms

Lab 7 — Build a filter evidence matrix

Learning outcome: LO2.

Goal: Parentheses make mixed and/or expressions explicit.

What you'll build

Evidence CSV and packet findings (Tools: Wireshark, TShark, Python.)

Step-by-step

1. Prepare your lab workspace. Open this lab folder in a terminal. Windows uses `py -3` in place of `python3`. Wireshark GUI alone is sufficient for the investigation; CLI scripts require TShark on PATH. Run the fixture verification first.

```
python3 scripts/verify.py
```

2. Open `data/branch-office.pcap`. Apply `dns.flags.rcode == 3` and record the returned response frame. Clear the filter and apply `tcp.flags.syn == 1`.
3. Compare `(ip.src == 192.0.2.10 && udp.port == 53) || tcp.port == 80` with `ip.src == 192.0.2.10 && (udp.port == 53 || tcp.port == 80)`. Record both counts and the direction excluded by the second expression.
4. Apply `!(ip.addr == 192.0.2.53)`. Verify that DNS packets disappear; compare `ip.addr != 192.0.2.53` on Wireshark 4.6 or later. Record the actual version and equality behaviour.
5. Save five useful filters in `outputs/filters.txt`. For each, state the question, filter and matching frame numbers; compile them with `scripts/verify.py`.
6. Export a reproducible packet table. Record the filter, frame numbers, measurement, explanation and limitation in `outputs/findings.md`.

```
python3 scripts/export_evidence.py
```

Test it

The supplied `dns.flags.rcode == 3` expression matches 1 frame(s) in the specified capture. Run `scripts/verify.py` and compare the listed frame numbers. Keep your findings and exported table in `outputs/`. Explain the observed result rather than only copying a count.

dns.flags.rcode == 3					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
6	0.070000	192.0.2.53	192.0.2.10	DNS	Standard query response 0x0066 No such name A mis...
branch-office.pcap Displayed: 1					

Lab 7 expected evidence — the packet list your filter should produce

Troubleshooting

TShark not found: install Wireshark CLI tools and add the installation folder to PATH; on Windows use the Wireshark install directory. A filter returns zero: clear other filters, use the specified capture, and check the expression is in the display toolbar. TLS remains opaque: select the matching `lab-tls.keys` file by absolute path, reload, and remove a key-log preference from another lab.

Try it with TShark

```
tshark -n -r data/branch-office.pcap -Y "dns.flags.rcode == 3"
```

Challenge

Develop and explain an alternative filter.

Reflection

Which second observation point would strengthen your conclusion?

Extension (optional)

Rewrite two of your matrix filters with the set (in {...}) and matches operators and confirm the frame lists are unchanged.

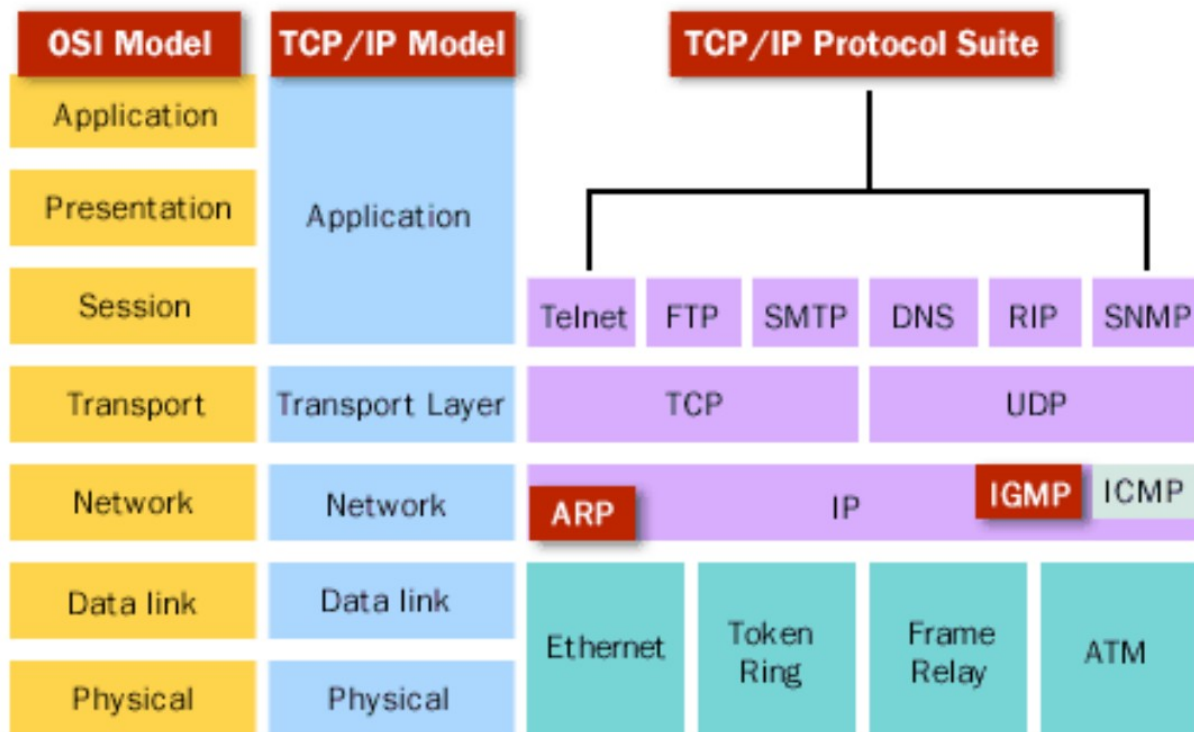
Note: Printable copy: [labs/lab-07-build-a-filter-evidence-matrix/LAB-07-Instructions.pdf](#). Use the README in the matching [labs/lab-NN-title/](#) folder. Capture only with permission.

Topic 08 — TCP/IP Communications and Resolution

Reconstruct an application dependency chain

Key concepts

- ARP resolves a local next-hop MAC; DNS resolves a name to an address.
- The destination IP stays end-to-end across routing while link-layer addresses change per hop.
- Resolution, connection establishment and application exchange form a dependency chain.



The TCP/IP Protocol Suite — Where common protocols sit

Lab 8 — Reconstruct an application dependency chain

Learning outcome: LO2.

Goal: ARP resolves a local next-hop MAC; DNS resolves a name to an address.

What you'll build

Evidence CSV and packet findings (Tools: Wireshark, TShark, Python.)

Step-by-step

1. Prepare your lab workspace. Open this lab folder in a terminal. Windows uses `py -3` in place of `python3`. Wireshark GUI alone is sufficient for the investigation; CLI scripts require TShark on PATH. Run the fixture verification first.

```
python3 scripts/verify.py
```

2. Open `data/branch-office.pcap`. Locate the ARP exchange and DNS transaction 101 for `portal.example.test`. Record the server address `192.0.2.20`.
3. Apply `tcp.stream == 0` and open Statistics > Flow Graph with displayed packets selected. Identify SYN, SYN/ACK, ACK, request and response.
4. Fill `assets/dependency-map.md` with the ARP, DNS, TCP and HTTP frame ranges. Distinguish Ethernet next hop from IP destination.

5. Contrast a same-subnet server with a routed server using assets/topology.md: a routed destination needs the gateway MAC rather than ARP for the remote host. Record what this trace can and cannot demonstrate.
6. Export a reproducible packet table. Record the filter, frame numbers, measurement, explanation and limitation in outputs/findings.md.

```
python3 scripts/export_evidence.py
```

Test it

The supplied `dns.qry.name == "portal.example.test"` expression matches 2 frame(s) in the specified capture. Run `scripts/verify.py` and compare the listed frame numbers. Keep your findings and exported table in `outputs/`. Explain the observed result rather than only copying a count.

dns.qry.name == "portal.example.test"					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
3	0.020000	192.0.2.10	192.0.2.53	DNS	Standard query 0x0065 A portal.example.test
4	0.040000	192.0.2.53	192.0.2.10	DNS	Standard query response 0x0065 A portal.example.t...
branch-office.pcap Displayed: 2					

Lab 8 expected evidence — the packet list your filter should produce

Troubleshooting

TShark not found: install Wireshark CLI tools and add the installation folder to PATH; on Windows use the Wireshark install directory. A filter returns zero: clear other filters, use the specified capture, and check the expression is in the display toolbar. TLS remains opaque: select the matching lab-tls.keys file by absolute path, reload, and remove a key-log preference from another lab.

Try it with TShark

```
tshark -n -r data/branch-office.pcap -Y "arp || dns.id == 0x0065 || tcp.stream == 0"
```

Challenge

Develop and explain an alternative filter.

Reflection

Which second observation point would strengthen your conclusion?

Extension (optional)

Ethernet and ARP lab — trace the dependency chain for a page you load on an authorised network. Source: J.F. Kurose and K.W. Ross, Wireshark Labs (gaia.cs.umass.edu/kurose_ross/wireshark.php).

Note: Printable copy: labs/lab-08-reconstruct-an-application-dependency-chain/LAB-08-Instructions.pdf. Use the README in the matching labs/lab-NN-title/ folder. Capture only with permission.

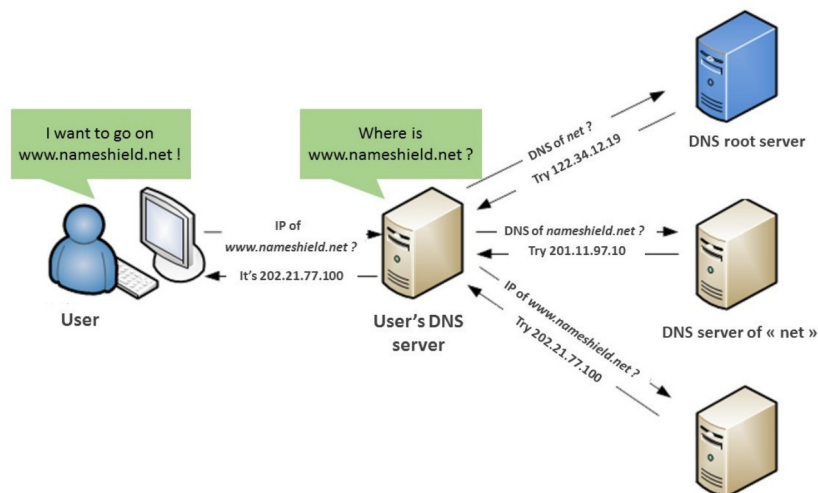
Topic 09 — DNS Traffic Analysis

Diagnose DNS failure and delay

Key concepts

- Transaction ID plus addresses and ports pair a query with its response.
- NXDOMAIN reports that a name does not exist; it differs from silence or timeout.
- DNS response time is a measured exchange, influenced by resolver and path behaviour.

Domain Name System (DNS) provides host name-to-IP address resolution services.



How DNS Works — Name resolution through a local resolver

Lab 9 — Diagnose DNS failure and delay

Learning outcome: LO3.

Goal: Transaction ID plus addresses and ports pair a query with its response.

What you'll build

Evidence CSV and packet findings (Tools: Wireshark, TShark, Python.)

Step-by-step

1. Prepare your lab workspace. Open this lab folder in a terminal. Windows uses `py -3` in place of `python3`. Wireshark GUI alone is sufficient for the investigation; CLI scripts require TShark on PATH. Run the fixture verification first.

```
python3 scripts/verify.py
```

2. Open `data/branch-office.pcap`. Apply `dns` and add `dns.time` as a column from a response packet. Pair IDs 101, 102 and 103.
3. Apply `dns.flags.rcode == 3`. Expand DNS flags and name. Record `missing.example.test` and explain NXDOMAIN.
4. Apply `dns.id == 103`. Measure the query-response interval: 0.800 seconds. Compare with the two 0.020 second transactions.
5. Complete `assets/dns-observations.csv` with name, transaction ID, rcode, elapsed seconds and next investigation. Do not label this measured delay as a DNS timeout.
6. Export a reproducible packet table. Record the filter, frame numbers, measurement, explanation and limitation in `outputs/findings.md`.

```
python3 scripts/export_evidence.py
```

Test it

The supplied `dns.flags.rcode == 3` expression matches 1 frame(s) in the specified capture. Run `scripts/verify.py` and compare the listed frame numbers. Keep your findings and exported table in `outputs/`. Explain the observed result rather than only copying a count.

dns.flags.rcode == 3					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
6	0.070000	192.0.2.53	192.0.2.10	DNS	Standard query response 0x0066 No such name A mis...
branch-office.pcap Displayed: 1					

Lab 9 expected evidence — the packet list your filter should produce

Troubleshooting

TShark not found: install Wireshark CLI tools and add the installation folder to PATH; on Windows use the Wireshark install directory. A filter returns zero: clear other filters, use the specified capture, and check the expression is in the display toolbar. TLS remains opaque: select the matching `lab-tls.keys` file by absolute path, reload, and remove a key-log preference from another lab.

Try it with TShark

```
tshark -n -r data/branch-office.pcap -Y "dns.flags.response == 1" -T fields -e dns.id -e dns.qry.name -e dns.flags.rcode -e dns.time
```

Challenge

Develop and explain an alternative filter.

Reflection

Which second observation point would strengthen your conclusion?

Extension (optional)

DNS lab — compare A, NS and MX lookups in the DNS trace from the Kurose & Ross labs. Source: J.F. Kurose and K.W. Ross, Wireshark Labs (gaia.cs.umass.edu/kurose_ross/wireshark.php).

Note: Printable copy: [labs/lab-09-diagnose-dns-failure-and-delay/LAB-09-Instructions.pdf](#). Use the README in the matching `labs/lab-NN-title/` folder. Capture only with permission.

Topic 10 — ARP Traffic Analysis

Verify link-local resolution

Key concepts

- ARP requests are link-local broadcasts; replies usually return to the requester.
- A repeated unresolved request suggests a local resolution problem, but a single trace may miss the reply.
- MAC changes require corroboration before claiming duplicate IP or spoofing.

Lab 10 — Verify link-local resolution

Learning outcome: LO3.

Goal: ARP requests are link-local broadcasts; replies usually return to the requester.

What you'll build

Evidence CSV and packet findings (Tools: Wireshark, TShark, Python.)

Step-by-step

1. Prepare your lab workspace. Open this lab folder in a terminal. Windows uses `py -3` in place of `python3`. Wireshark GUI alone is sufficient for the investigation; CLI scripts require TShark on PATH. Run the fixture verification first.

```
python3 scripts/verify.py
```

2. Open `data/branch-office.pcap`. Apply `arp`. Expand the request and reply, then record sender IP, sender MAC, target IP and opcode.
3. Apply `arp.opcode == 2`. Confirm the advertised server mapping is 192.0.2.20 to 02:00:00:00:00:20.
4. Use the packet bytes to verify the opcode field is 2 in the reply. Add the mapping to `assets/arp-table.csv`.

5. Compare assets/arp-hypotheses.md with the evidence. State that this capture shows one successful exchange, without inventing repeated failures or conflicting MACs.
6. Export a reproducible packet table. Record the filter, frame numbers, measurement, explanation and limitation in outputs/findings.md.

```
python3 scripts/export_evidence.py
```

Test it

The supplied arp.opcode == 2 expression matches 1 frame(s) in the specified capture. Run scripts/verify.py and compare the listed frame numbers. Keep your findings and exported table in outputs/. Explain the observed result rather than only copying a count.

arp.opcode == 2					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
2	0.010000	02:00:00:00:00:20	02:00:00:00:00:10	ARP	192.0.2.20 is at 02:00:00:00:00:20
branch-office.pcap Displayed: 1					

Lab 10 expected evidence — the packet list your filter should produce

Troubleshooting

TShark not found: install Wireshark CLI tools and add the installation folder to PATH; on Windows use the Wireshark install directory. A filter returns zero: clear other filters, use the specified capture, and check the expression is in the display toolbar. TLS remains opaque: select the matching lab-tls.keys file by absolute path, reload, and remove a key-log preference from another lab.

Try it with TShark

```
tshark -n -r data/branch-office.pcap -Y arp -T fields -e arp.opcode -e arp.src.proto_ipv4 -e arp.src.hw_mac
```

Challenge

Develop and explain an alternative filter.

Reflection

Which second observation point would strengthen your conclusion?

Extension (optional)

Ethernet and ARP lab — read the ARP cache on your own machine (arp -a) and match it to captured replies. Source: J.F. Kurose and K.W. Ross, Wireshark Labs (gaia.cs.umass.edu/kurose_ross/wireshark.php).

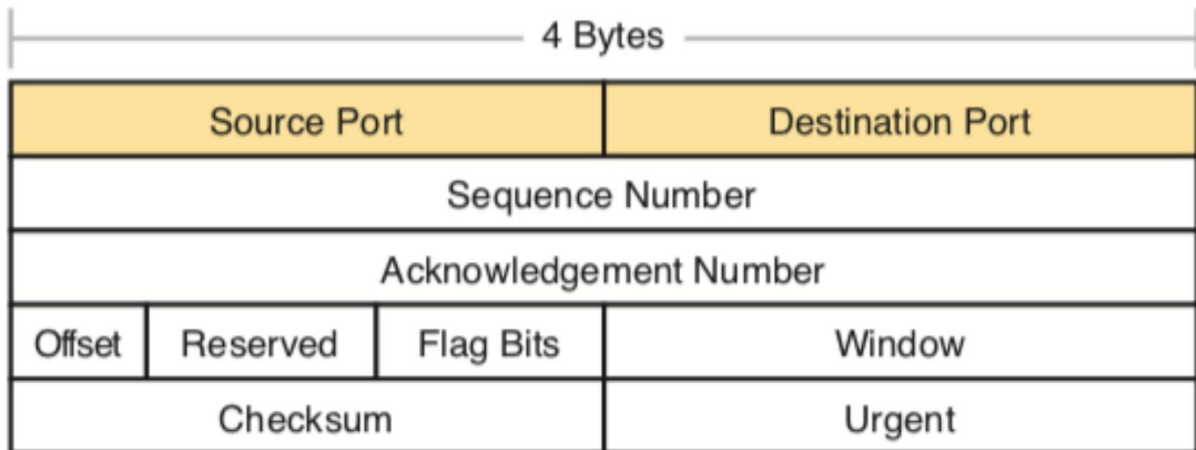
Note: Printable copy: labs/lab-10-verify-link-local-resolution/LAB-10-Instructions.pdf. Use the README in the matching labs/lab-NN-title/ folder. Capture only with permission.

Topic 11 — IPv4 Traffic Analysis

Classify IPv4 scope and headers

Key concepts

- TTL limits forwarding hops; it is not a latency measurement.
- Broadcast and multicast use different addressing scopes and delivery rules.
- Fragmentation fields describe packet handling; missing fragments can reflect capture limitations.



IPv4 Header Essentials — Header layout (TCP header shown; IPv4 uses the same 32-bit rows)

Lab 11 — Classify IPv4 scope and headers

Learning outcome: LO3.

Goal: TTL limits forwarding hops; it is not a latency measurement.

What you'll build

Evidence CSV and packet findings (Tools: Wireshark, TShark, Python.)

Step-by-step

1. Prepare your lab workspace. Open this lab folder in a terminal. Windows uses `py -3` in place of `python3`. Wireshark GUI alone is sufficient for the investigation; CLI scripts require TShark on PATH. Run the fixture verification first.

```
python3 scripts/verify.py
```

2. Open `data/branch-office.pcap`. Select an ICMP echo request. Expand IPv4 and record version, IHL, total length, TTL, protocol, flags and fragment offset.
3. Apply `ip.dst == 224.0.0.1` and compare Ethernet destination `01:00:5e:00:00:01` with IPv4 multicast destination. Record TTL 1.
4. Apply `ip.flags.mf == 1 || ip.frag_offset > 0`. Confirm no fragmented packets in this fixture; absence here does not demonstrate a universal MTU.

5. Complete assets/ip-header.csv. Explain why ARP broadcast is not an IPv4 broadcast packet, and why a capture at one point cannot estimate hop count from TTL without knowing initial TTL.
6. Export a reproducible packet table. Record the filter, frame numbers, measurement, explanation and limitation in outputs/findings.md.

```
python3 scripts/export_evidence.py
```

Test it

The supplied `ip.dst == 224.0.0.1` expression matches 1 frame(s) in the specified capture. Run `scripts/verify.py` and compare the listed frame numbers. Keep your findings and exported table in `outputs/`. Explain the observed result rather than only copying a count.

ip.dst == 224.0.0.1					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
17	1.030000	192.0.2.10	224.0.0.1	UDP	55001 → 5000 Len=13
branch-office.pcap Displayed: 1					

Lab 11 expected evidence — the packet list your filter should produce

Troubleshooting

TShark not found: install Wireshark CLI tools and add the installation folder to PATH; on Windows use the Wireshark install directory. A filter returns zero: clear other filters, use the specified capture, and check the expression is in the display toolbar. TLS remains opaque: select the matching lab-tls.keys file by absolute path, reload, and remove a key-log preference from another lab.

Try it with TShark

```
tshark -n -r data/branch-office.pcap -Y "ip.dst == 224.0.0.1" -T fields
-e eth.dst -e ip.dst -e ip.ttl
```

Challenge

Develop and explain an alternative filter.

Reflection

Which second observation point would strengthen your conclusion?

Extension (optional)

IP lab — study TTL and fragmentation in the traceroute trace from the Kurose & Ross labs. Source: J.F. Kurose and K.W. Ross, Wireshark Labs (gaia.cs.umass.edu/kurose_ross/wireshark.php).

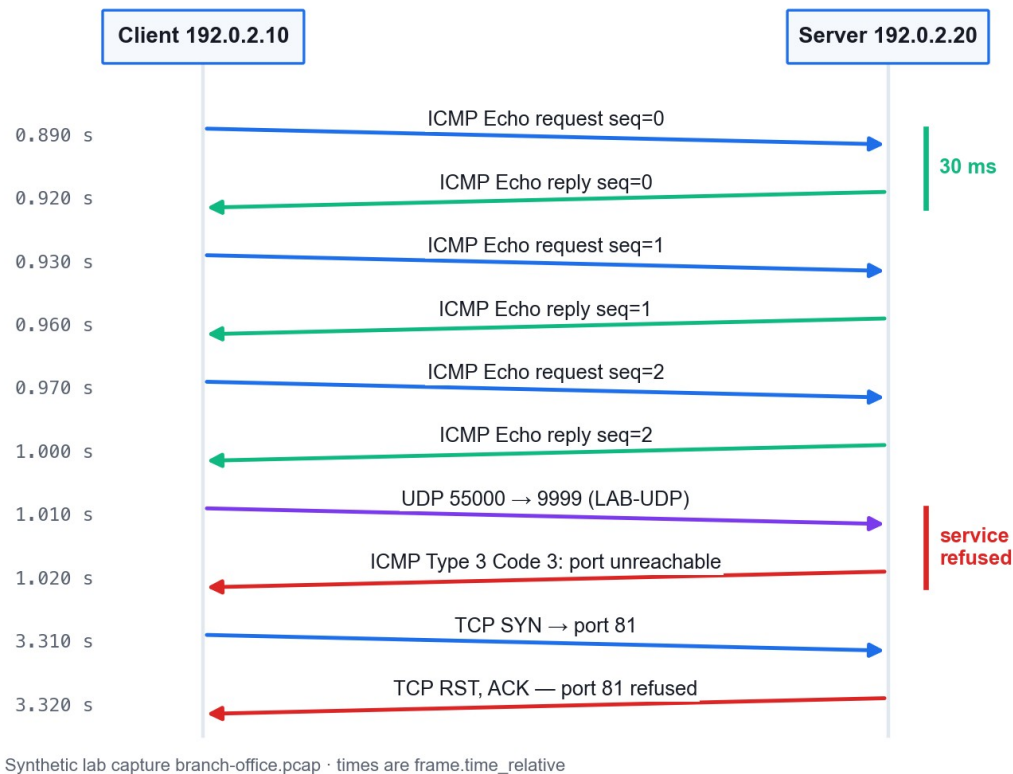
Note: Printable copy: [labs/lab-11-classify-ipv4-scope-and-headers/LAB-11-Instructions.pdf](#). Use the README in the matching `labs/lab-NN-title/` folder. Capture only with permission.

Topic 12 — ICMP Traffic Analysis

Interpret echo and unreachable messages

Key concepts

- Echo requests/replies show an IP exchange; they do not guarantee an application works.
- Destination unreachable messages quote the offending datagram.
- ICMP may be filtered or rate-limited, so absence of a reply needs cautious interpretation.



Echo, Refusal and Reset in the Lab Capture — Frames 9–16 and 55–56

Lab 12 — Interpret echo and unreachable messages

Learning outcome: LO3.

Goal: Echo requests/replies show an IP exchange; they do not guarantee an application works.

What you'll build

Evidence CSV and packet findings (Tools: Wireshark, TShark, Python.)

Step-by-step

1. Prepare your lab workspace. Open this lab folder in a terminal. Windows uses `py -3` in place of `python3`. Wireshark GUI alone is sufficient for the investigation; CLI scripts require TShark on PATH. Run the fixture verification first.

```
python3 scripts/verify.py
```

2. Open `data/branch-office.pcap`. Apply `icmp.type == 8 || icmp.type == 0`. Pair echo sequences 0, 1 and 2 using identifier 7. Measure 0.030 seconds per pair.
3. Apply `icmp.type == 3 && icmp.code == 3`. Expand the quoted IPv4 and UDP headers. Record destination UDP port 9999.
4. Apply `udp.dstport == 9999` to locate the initiating datagram. Record the difference between a UDP service refusal and an echo reply.
5. Complete `assets/icmp-events.csv` with type, code, quoted protocol, port and conclusion. State which evidence supports a service refusal.
6. Export a reproducible packet table. Record the filter, frame numbers, measurement, explanation and limitation in `outputs/findings.md`.

```
python3 scripts/export_evidence.py
```

Test it

The supplied `icmp.type == 3 && icmp.code == 3` expression matches 1 frame(s) in the specified capture. Run `scripts/verify.py` and compare the listed frame numbers. Keep your findings and exported table in `outputs/`. Explain the observed result rather than only copying a count.

icmp.type == 3 && icmp.code == 3					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
16	1.020000	192.0.2.20	192.0.2.10	ICMP	Destination unreachable (Port unreachable)
branch-office.pcap Displayed: 1					

Lab 12 expected evidence — the packet list your filter should produce

Troubleshooting

TShark not found: install Wireshark CLI tools and add the installation folder to PATH; on Windows use the Wireshark install directory. A filter returns zero: clear other filters, use the specified capture, and check the expression is in the display toolbar. TLS remains opaque: select the matching `lab-tls.keys` file by absolute path, reload, and remove a key-log preference from another lab.

Try it with TShark

```
tshark -n -r data/branch-office.pcap -Y icmp -T fields -e frame.number  
-e icmp.type -e icmp.code -e icmp.seq
```

Challenge

Develop and explain an alternative filter.

Reflection

Which second observation point would strengthen your conclusion?

Extension (optional)

ICMP lab — identify Time Exceeded (type 11) messages in the traceroute trace. Source: J.F. Kurose and K.W. Ross, Wireshark Labs (gaia.cs.umass.edu/kurose_ross/wireshark.php).

Note: Printable copy: [labs/lab-12-interpret-echo-and-unreachable-messages/LAB-12-Instructions.pdf](#). Use the README in the matching [labs/lab-NN-title/](#) folder. Capture only with permission.

Topic 13 — UDP Traffic Analysis

Follow datagrams and service refusal

Key concepts

- UDP has no transport handshake or retransmission; the application may provide reliability.
- A port number is a decoding hint; payload and context identify the application.
- Following a UDP stream collects datagrams and does not invent missing data.

	TCP	UDP																							
Acronym	Transmission Control Protocol	User Datagram Protocol																							
Reliability	High	Best Effort																							
Header Size	4 Bytes <table><tr><td colspan="2">Source Port</td><td colspan="2">Destination Port</td></tr><tr><td colspan="4">Sequence Number</td></tr><tr><td colspan="4">Acknowledgement Number</td></tr><tr><td>Offset</td><td>Reserved</td><td>Flag Bits</td><td>Window</td></tr><tr><td colspan="2">Checksum</td><td colspan="2">Urgent</td></tr></table> Figure 5-1 TCP Header Fields 4x5=20 Byte 4 Bytes <table><tr><td>Source Port</td><td>Destination Port</td></tr><tr><td>Length</td><td>Checksum</td></tr></table> Figure 5-10 UDP Header 4x2=8 Byte	Source Port		Destination Port		Sequence Number				Acknowledgement Number				Offset	Reserved	Flag Bits	Window	Checksum		Urgent		Source Port	Destination Port	Length	Checksum
Source Port		Destination Port																							
Sequence Number																									
Acknowledgement Number																									
Offset	Reserved	Flag Bits	Window																						
Checksum		Urgent																							
Source Port	Destination Port																								
Length	Checksum																								

TCP vs UDP — Header and feature comparison

Lab 13 — Follow datagrams and service refusal

Learning outcome: LO3.

Goal: UDP has no transport handshake or retransmission; the application may provide reliability.

What you'll build

Evidence CSV and packet findings (Tools: Wireshark, TShark, Python.)

Step-by-step

1. Prepare your lab workspace. Open this lab folder in a terminal. Windows uses `py -3` in place of `python3`. Wireshark GUI alone is sufficient for the investigation; CLI scripts require TShark on PATH. Run the fixture verification first.

```
python3 scripts/verify.py
```

2. Open `data/branch-office.pcap`. Apply `udp.dstport == 9999`. One frame is the original datagram and one is the UDP header quoted inside ICMP; inspect the outer protocol to distinguish them.
3. Select the original datagram and use `Analyze > Follow > UDP Stream`. Confirm the payload LAB-UDP. Save a text view to `outputs/udp-stream.txt`.
4. Apply `udp.port == 4002` and decode RTP using `Analyze > Decode As`. Compare datagram framing with the earlier TCP stream.
5. Record why no UDP transport ACK exists in the trace. Use the ICMP refusal to explain why an application can fail even though a datagram was transmitted.
6. Export a reproducible packet table. Record the filter, frame numbers, measurement, explanation and limitation in `outputs/findings.md`.

```
python3 scripts/export_evidence.py
```

Test it

The supplied `udp.dstport == 9999` expression matches 2 frame(s) in the specified capture. Run `scripts/verify.py` and compare the listed frame numbers. Keep your findings and exported table in `outputs/`. Explain the observed result rather than only copying a count.

udp.dstport == 9999					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
15	1.010000	192.0.2.10	192.0.2.20	UDP	55000 → 9999 Len=7
16	1.020000	192.0.2.20	192.0.2.10	ICMP	Destination unreachable (Port unreachable)
branch-office.pcap Displayed: 2					

Lab 13 expected evidence — the packet list your filter should produce

Troubleshooting

TShark not found: install Wireshark CLI tools and add the installation folder to PATH; on Windows use the Wireshark install directory. A filter returns zero: clear other filters, use the specified capture, and check the expression is in the display toolbar. TLS remains opaque: select the matching `lab-tls.keys` file by absolute path, reload, and remove a key-log preference from another lab.

Try it with TShark

```
tshark -n -r data/branch-office.pcap -q -z follow,udp,ascii,3
```

Challenge

Develop and explain an alternative filter.

Reflection

Which second observation point would strengthen your conclusion?

Extension (optional)

UDP lab — examine UDP header fields and lengths in the UDP trace from the Kurose & Ross labs. Source: J.F. Kurose and K.W. Ross, Wireshark Labs (gaia.cs.umass.edu/kurose_ross/wireshark.php).

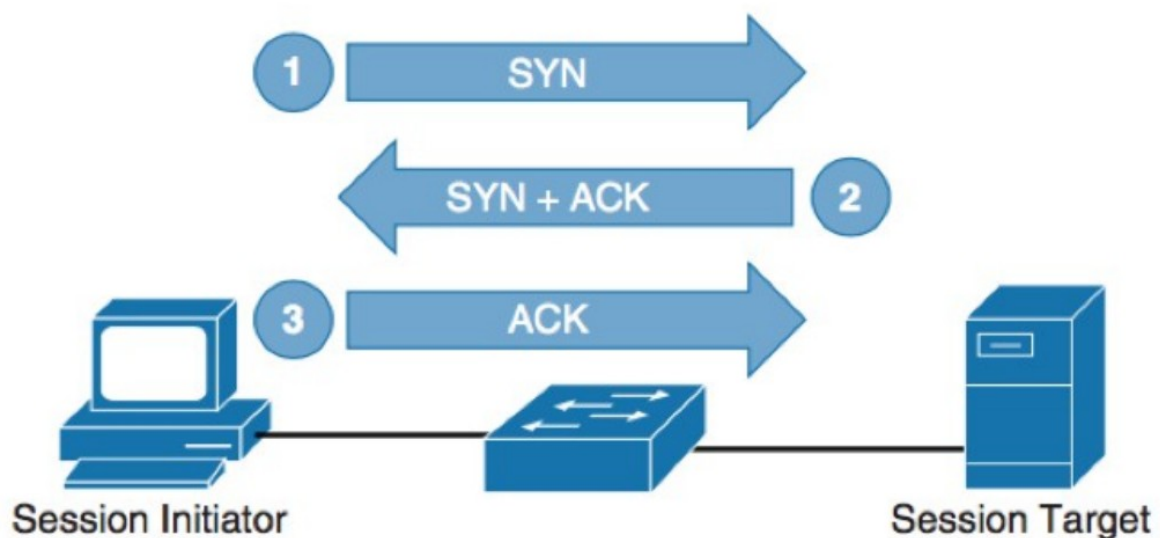
Note: Printable copy: [labs/lab-13-follow-datagrams-and-service-refusal/LAB-13-Instructions.pdf](#). Use the README in the matching [labs/lab-NN-title/](#) folder. Capture only with permission.

Topic 14 — TCP Protocol Analysis

Investigate retransmission and zero window

Key concepts

- Sequence numbers count bytes; ACK numbers indicate the next expected byte.
- Retransmission and duplicate ACK labels are heuristics sensitive to capture placement and completeness.
- Zero window indicates receive-side flow control; it is distinct from network congestion.



The Three-Way Handshake — Connection establishment

Lab 14 — Investigate retransmission and zero window

Learning outcome: LO4.

Goal: Sequence numbers count bytes; ACK numbers indicate the next expected byte.

What you'll build

Evidence CSV and packet findings (Tools: Wireshark, TShark, Python.)

Step-by-step

1. Prepare your lab workspace. Open this lab folder in a terminal. Windows uses `py -3` in place of `python3`. Wireshark GUI alone is sufficient for the investigation; CLI scripts require TShark on PATH. Run the fixture verification first.

```
python3 scripts/verify.py
```

2. Open `data/branch-office.pcap`. Apply `tcp.stream == 3`. Open Analyze > Expert Information and note the repeated server segment.
3. Apply `tcp.analysis.retransmission` and expand TCP. Compare the same sequence range and payload in the earlier segment; the repeat occurs 1.000 second later.
4. Apply `tcp.window_size_value == 0`. Confirm the client ACK advertises zero receive window in stream 3. Examine the SYN options: window scaling is negotiated, but zero remains zero.
5. Apply `tcp.flags.reset == 1`. Identify the port 81 refusal. Complete `assets/tcp-evidence.csv` with stream, frame, flag/analysis, measured interval and a limitation. Discuss SACK, fast recovery and out-of-order evidence without claiming those events occur in this fixture.
6. Export a reproducible packet table. Record the filter, frame numbers, measurement, explanation and limitation in `outputs/findings.md`.

```
python3 scripts/export_evidence.py
```

Test it

The supplied `tcp.analysis.retransmission` expression matches 1 frame(s) in the specified capture. Run `scripts/verify.py` and compare the listed frame numbers. Keep your findings and exported table in `outputs/`. Explain the observed result rather than only copying a count.

tcp.analysis.retransmission					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
51	3.270000	192.0.2.20	192.0.2.10	TCP	[TCP Retransmission] 80 → 51004 [PSH, ACK] Seq=1 ...
branch-office.pcap Displayed: 1					
tcp.analysis.zero_window					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
52	3.280000	192.0.2.10	192.0.2.20	TCP	[TCP ZeroWindow] 51004 → 80 [ACK] Seq=70 Ack=93 W...
branch-office.pcap Displayed: 1					
tcp.flags.reset == 1					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
56	3.320000	192.0.2.20	192.0.2.10	TCP	81 → 52000 [RST, ACK] Seq=1 Ack=1 Win=8192 Len=0
branch-office.pcap Displayed: 1					

Lab 14 expected evidence — the packet list your filter should produce

Troubleshooting

TShark not found: install Wireshark CLI tools and add the installation folder to PATH; on Windows use the Wireshark install directory. A filter returns zero: clear other filters, use the specified capture, and check the expression is in the display toolbar. TLS remains opaque: select the matching lab-tls.keys file by absolute path, reload, and remove a key-log preference from another lab.

Try it with TShark

```
tshark -n -r data/branch-office.pcap -q -z expert
```

Challenge

Develop and explain an alternative filter.

Reflection

Which second observation point would strengthen your conclusion?

Extension (optional)

TCP lab — find retransmissions and window behaviour in a larger file transfer trace.

Source: J.F. Kurose and K.W. Ross, Wireshark Labs

(gaia.cs.umass.edu/kurose_ross/wireshark.php).

Note: Printable copy: [labs/lab-14-investigate-retransmission-and-zero-window/LAB-14-Instructions.pdf](#). Use the README in the matching `labs/lab-NN-title/` folder. Capture only with permission.

Topic 15 — Traffic Graphs

Graph bytes, RTT and recovery

Key concepts

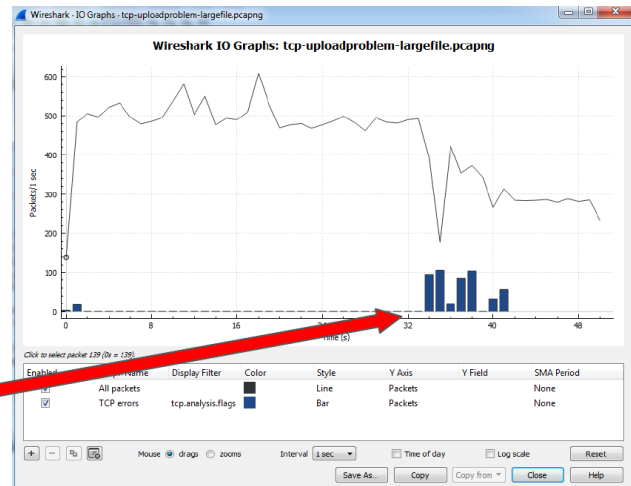
- An I/O graph bins observed events; units and interval determine what it means.
- TCP time-sequence graphs show byte progress, stalls and repeated sequence ranges.
- RTT samples, application response time and throughput answer different questions.

SMA → Smooth Moving Average

Log Scale

Use when there is a relatively large difference between the two numerical values and the relationship can be difficult to see.

WindowZero, DupAck, etc.



I/O Graphs — Multiple graphs with different filters on one chart

Lab 15 — Graph bytes, RTT and recovery

Learning outcome: LO4.

Goal: An I/O graph bins observed events; units and interval determine what it means.

What you'll build

Evidence CSV and packet findings (Tools: Wireshark, TShark, Python.)

Step-by-step

1. Prepare your lab workspace. Open this lab folder in a terminal. Windows uses `py -3` in place of `python3`. Wireshark GUI alone is sufficient for the investigation; CLI scripts require TShark on PATH. Run the fixture verification first.

```
python3 scripts/verify.py
```

2. Open data/branch-office.pcap. Select a packet in TCP stream 3. Open Statistics > TCP Stream Graphs > Time Sequence (Stevens) and inspect the repeated server sequence.

3. Open Statistics > I/O Graphs. Add a retransmission graph with filter `tcp.analysis.retransmission` and a zero-window graph with filter `tcp.analysis.zero_window`. Use packets and a 1 second interval; record their event bins.
4. Open TCP Stream Graphs > Round Trip Time. Compare eligible ACK samples with the 30 ms SYN-to-SYN/ACK interval and the 40 ms complete handshake/initial_rtt on the final ACK. Explain why no ACK sample exists for an unacknowledged segment before its repeat.
5. Run the report script to export timestamps and byte lengths, then write `outputs/graph-notes.md` with interval, unit, stream, visible pattern and limitation. Do not use `SUM(tcp.seq)` as throughput.
6. Export a reproducible packet table. Record the filter, frame numbers, measurement, explanation and limitation in `outputs/findings.md`.

```
python3 scripts/export_evidence.py
```

Test it

The supplied `tcp.analysis.retransmission || tcp.analysis.zero_window` expression matches 2 frame(s) in the specified capture. Run `scripts/verify.py` and compare the listed frame numbers. Keep your findings and exported table in `outputs/`. Explain the observed result rather than only copying a count.

tcp.analysis.retransmission tcp.analysis.zero_window					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
51	3.270000	192.0.2.20	192.0.2.10	TCP	[TCP Retransmission] 80 → 51004 [PSH, ACK] Seq=1 ...
52	3.280000	192.0.2.10	192.0.2.20	TCP	[TCP ZeroWindow] 51004 → 80 [ACK] Seq=70 Ack=93 W...
branch-office.pcap Displayed: 2					

Lab 15 expected evidence — the packet list your filter should produce

Troubleshooting

TShark not found: install Wireshark CLI tools and add the installation folder to PATH; on Windows use the Wireshark install directory. A filter returns zero: clear other filters, use the specified capture, and check the expression is in the display toolbar. TLS remains opaque: select the matching `lab-tls.keys` file by absolute path, reload, and remove a key-log preference from another lab.

Try it with TShark

```
tshark -n -r data/branch-office.pcap -q -z
"io,stat,1,tcp.analysis.retransmission,tcp.analysis.zero_window"
```

Challenge

Develop and explain an alternative filter.

Reflection

Which second observation point would strengthen your conclusion?

Extension (optional)

TCP lab — draw the Stevens graph of the file upload trace and estimate throughput.

Source: J.F. Kurose and K.W. Ross, Wireshark Labs
(gaia.cs.umass.edu/kurose_ross/wireshark.php).

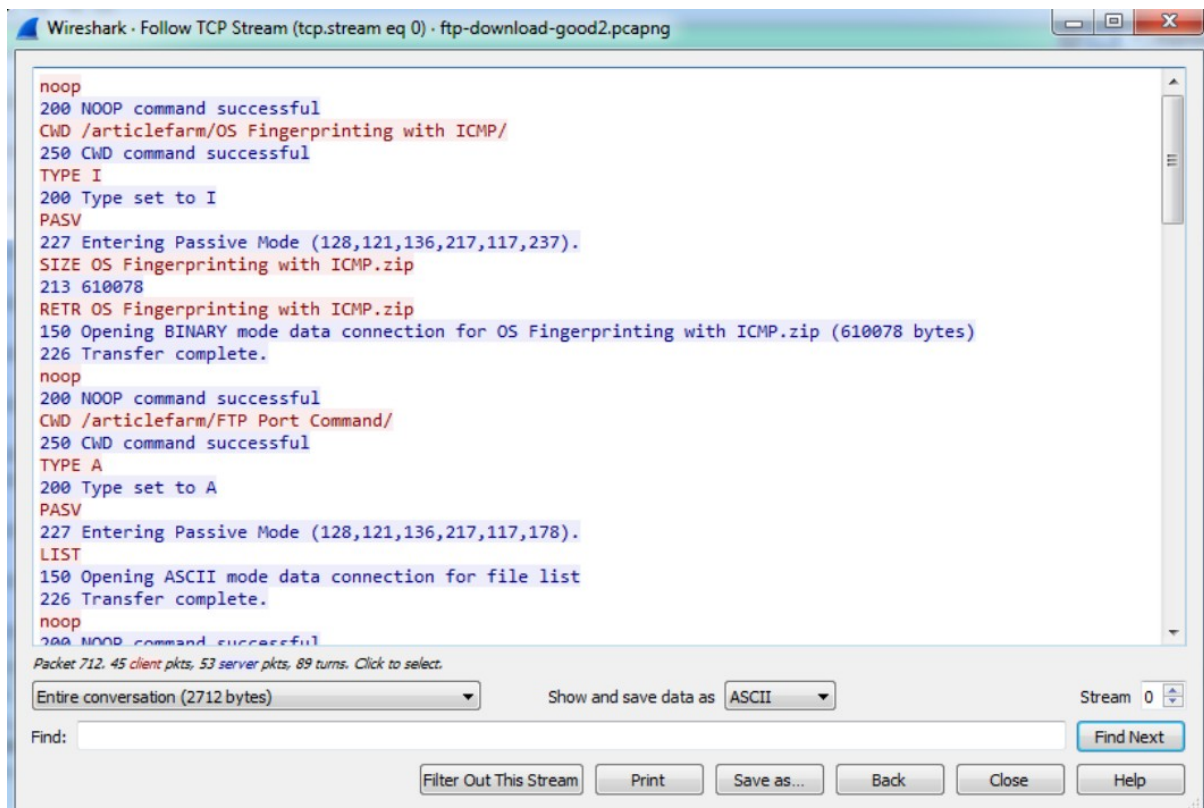
Note: Printable copy: [labs/lab-15-graph-bytes-rtt-and-recovery/LAB-15-Instructions.pdf](#). Use the README in the matching [labs/lab-NN-title/](#) folder. Capture only with permission.

Topic 16 — HTTP and HTTP/2 Analysis

Inspect HTTP outcomes and HTTP/2 frames

Key concepts

- HTTP response codes describe application outcomes after transport delivery.
- A response time contains more than network latency; pair the correct request and response.
- HTTP/2 multiplexes frames; encrypted HTTP/2 needs authorised TLS secrets to inspect payload.



Lab 16 — Inspect HTTP outcomes and HTTP/2 frames

Learning outcome: LO4.

Goal: HTTP response codes describe application outcomes after transport delivery.

What you'll build

Evidence CSV and packet findings (Tools: Wireshark, TShark, Python.)

Step-by-step

1. Prepare your lab workspace. Open this lab folder in a terminal. Windows uses `py -3` in place of `python3`. Wireshark GUI alone is sufficient for the investigation; CLI scripts require TShark on PATH. Run the fixture verification first.

```
python3 scripts/verify.py
```

2. Open `data/branch-office.pcap`. Apply `http.request || http.response`. Pair `/health`, `/slow`, `/missing` and `/fault` with their response codes.
3. Select the `/health` response and Follow > TCP Stream. Confirm LAB-OK. Use File > Export Objects > HTTP to save the health text object into `outputs/objects/`.
4. Apply `tcp.port == 8080`. Use Analyze > Decode As and set TCP port 8080 to HTTP2. Inspect the connection preface and SETTINGS frame (type 4). This fixture uses cleartext prior knowledge, not HTTPS.
5. Run `scripts/verify.py`, then save `outputs/http-summary.csv` with URI, status, response interval and proposed next step. Discuss how multiple HTTP/2 stream IDs share one TCP connection.
6. Export a reproducible packet table. Record the filter, frame numbers, measurement, explanation and limitation in `outputs/findings.md`.

```
python3 scripts/export_evidence.py
```

Test it

The supplied `http.response.code >= 400` expression matches 2 frame(s) in the specified capture. Run `scripts/verify.py` and compare the listed frame numbers. Keep your findings and exported table in `outputs/`. Explain the observed result rather than only copying a count.

http.response.code >= 400					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
41	2.130000	192.0.2.20	192.0.2.10	HTTP	HTTP/1.1 404 Not Found (text/plain)
50	2.270000	192.0.2.20	192.0.2.10	HTTP	HTTP/1.1 500 Internal Server Error (text/plain)
branch-office.pcap Displayed: 2					
http2.type == 4 [Decode As: tcp.port==8080,http2]					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
66	3.460000	192.0.2.10	192.0.2.20	HTTP2	Magic, SETTINGS[0]
branch-office.pcap Displayed: 1					

Troubleshooting

TShark not found: install Wireshark CLI tools and add the installation folder to PATH; on Windows use the Wireshark install directory. A filter returns zero: clear other filters, use the specified capture, and check the expression is in the display toolbar. TLS remains opaque: select the matching lab-tls.keys file by absolute path, reload, and remove a key-log preference from another lab.

Try it with TShark

```
tshark -n -r data/branch-office.pcap -q --export-objects  
http,outputs/objects
```

Challenge

Develop and explain an alternative filter.

Reflection

Which second observation point would strengthen your conclusion?

Extension (optional)

HTTP lab — compare conditional GET (304) behaviour in the HTTP traces. Hash every exported object with shasum -a 256. Source: J.F. Kurose and K.W. Ross, Wireshark Labs (gaia.cs.umass.edu/kurose_ross/wireshark.php).

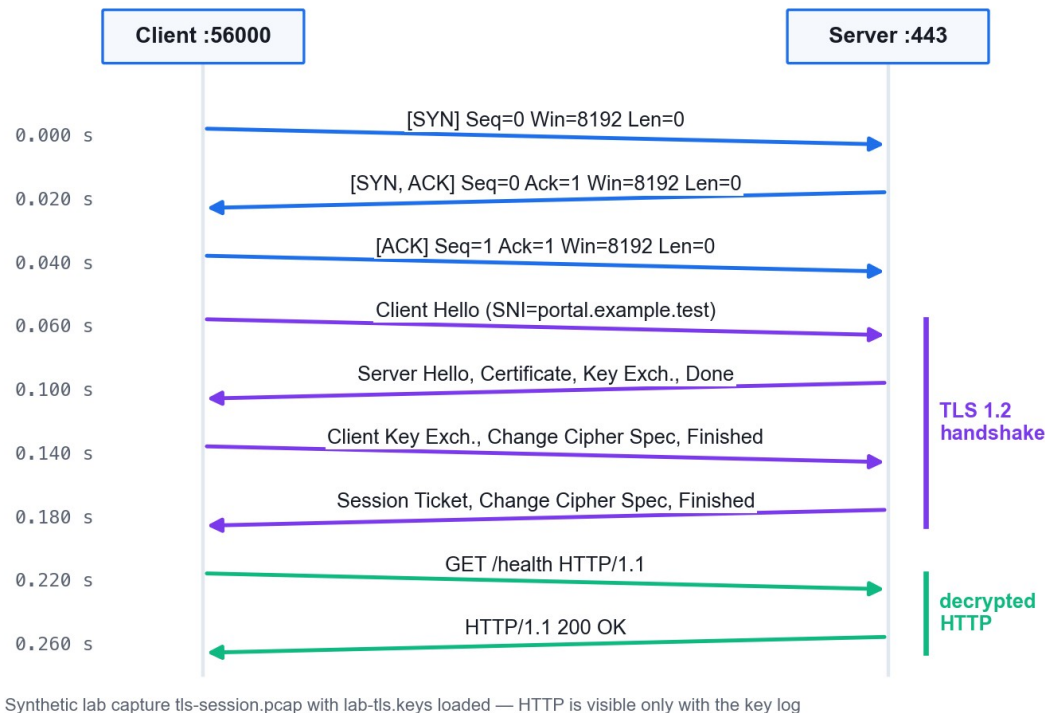
Note: Printable copy: [labs/lab-16-inspect-http-outcomes-and-http-2-frames/LAB-16-Instructions.pdf](#). Use the README in the matching [labs/lab-NN-title/](#) folder. Capture only with permission.

Topic 17 — TLS-Encrypted Traffic Analysis

Compare encrypted and decrypted views

Key concepts

- Without session secrets, encrypted application records do not disclose HTTP payload.
- A controlled key log enables authorised inspection of this synthetic TLS exchange.
- A server RSA private key alone cannot decrypt modern ECDHE or TLS 1.3 sessions.



TLS 1.2 Handshake in the Lab Capture — tls-session.pcap, decrypted view

Lab 17 — Compare encrypted and decrypted views

Learning outcome: LO4.

Goal: Without session secrets, encrypted application records do not disclose HTTP payload.

What you'll build

Evidence CSV and packet findings (Tools: Wireshark, TShark, Python.)

Step-by-step

1. Prepare your lab workspace. Open this lab folder in a terminal. Windows uses `py -3` in place of `python3`. Wireshark GUI alone is sufficient for the investigation; CLI scripts require TShark on PATH. Run the fixture verification first.

```
python3 scripts/verify.py
```

2. Open `data/tls-session.pcap`. In Preferences > Protocols > TLS, clear the (Pre)-Master-Secret log filename, then apply `tls`. Identify ClientHello and encrypted application records.
3. Expand ClientHello > Extensions > `server_name`. Record `portal.example.test`. The lab uses a real TLS 1.2 MemoryBIO exchange, a temporary self-signed certificate and offline synthetic TCP wrapping.

4. Set Preferences > Protocols > TLS > (Pre)-Master-Secret log filename to the absolute path of data/lab-tls.keys. Reload the capture. Apply http and confirm GET /health and 200 OK containing LAB-OK.
5. Run scripts/verify.py for both encrypted/decrypted checks. Clear the key-log preference when finished. The supplied secrets are synthetic lab session material; never copy production session secrets into a public repository.
6. Export a reproducible packet table. Record the filter, frame numbers, measurement, explanation and limitation in outputs/findings.md.

```
python3 scripts/export_evidence.py
```

Test it

The supplied `tls.handshake.type == 1` expression matches 1 frame(s) in the specified capture. Run `scripts/verify.py` and compare the listed frame numbers. Keep your findings and exported table in `outputs/`. Explain the observed result rather than only copying a count.

tls.handshake.type == 1					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
4	0.060000	192.0.2.10	192.0.2.20	TLSv1	Client Hello (SNI=portal.example.test)
tls-session.pcap Displayed: 1					
http.request					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
(no packets match – expected for this view)					
tls-session.pcap Displayed: 0					
http.request [TLS key log loaded]					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
12	0.220000	192.0.2.10	192.0.2.20	HTTP	GET /health HTTP/1.1
tls-session.pcap Displayed: 1					
http.response.code == 200 [TLS key log loaded]					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
14	0.260000	192.0.2.20	192.0.2.10	HTTP	HTTP/1.1 200 OK
tls-session.pcap Displayed: 1					

Lab 17 expected evidence — the packet list your filter should produce

Troubleshooting

TShark not found: install Wireshark CLI tools and add the installation folder to PATH; on Windows use the Wireshark install directory. A filter returns zero: clear other filters, use the specified capture, and check the expression is in the display toolbar. TLS remains opaque: select the matching lab-tls.keys file by absolute path, reload, and remove a key-log preference from another lab.

Try it with TShark

```
tshark -n -r data/tls-session.pcap -o tls.keylog_file:data/lab-tls.keys
-Y http
```

Challenge

Develop and explain an alternative filter.

Reflection

Which second observation point would strengthen your conclusion?

Extension (optional)

TLS lab — identify the handshake records and cipher suite in the TLS trace from the Kurose & Ross labs. Source: J.F. Kurose and K.W. Ross, Wireshark Labs (gaia.cs.umass.edu/kurose_ross/wireshark.php).

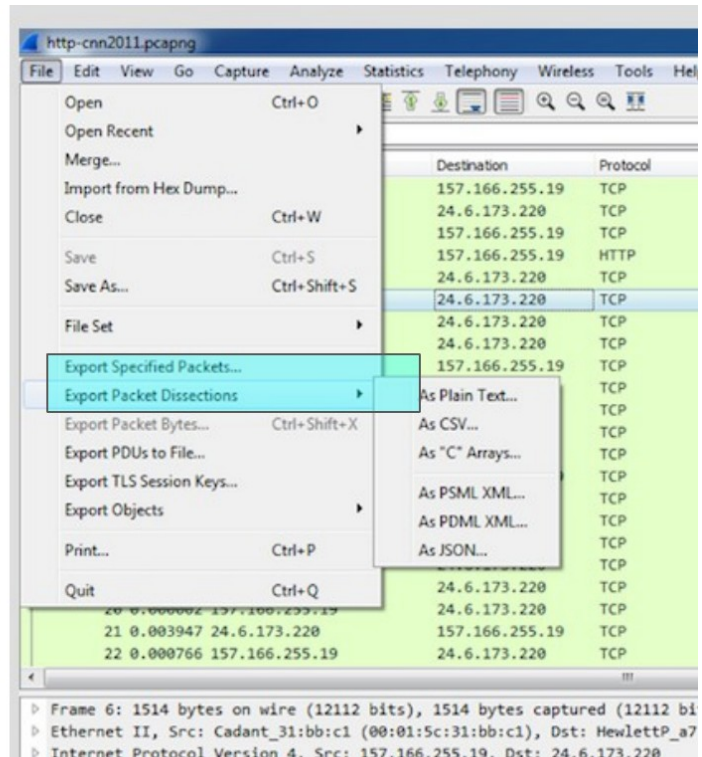
Note: Printable copy: [labs/lab-17-compare-encrypted-and-decrypt-ed-views/LAB-17-Instructions.pdf](#). Use the README in the matching [labs/lab-NN-title/](#) folder. Capture only with permission.

Topic 18 — Ten Troubleshooting Steps and Reporting

Produce an evidence-led incident report

Key concepts

- Begin with scope and a baseline, then focus with endpoints, filters, time and graphs.
- Separate observed facts from hypotheses and specify what new evidence would test them.
- A useful report states affected flow, measurement, impact, recommended action and uncertainty.



Export and Preserve Evidence — File | Export Packet Dissections

Lab 18 — Produce an evidence-led incident report

Learning outcome: LO5.

Goal: Begin with scope and a baseline, then focus with endpoints, filters, time and graphs.

What you'll build

Evidence CSV and packet findings (Tools: Wireshark, TShark, Python.)

Step-by-step

1. Prepare your lab workspace. Open this lab folder in a terminal. Windows uses `py` -3 in place of `python3`. Wireshark GUI alone is sufficient for the investigation; CLI scripts require TShark on PATH. Run the fixture verification first.

```
python3 scripts/verify.py
```

2. Open `data/branch-office.pcap`. Read `assets/incident-ticket.md`. Use Statistics > Conversations, filters and Expert Information to identify the failing /fault request.
3. Record evidence for the DNS delay, slow HTTP response, retransmission, zero window and port 81 refusal. Use exact frames and elapsed times rather than a claim that every symptom has one cause.

4. Complete assets/report-template.md and save as outputs/incident-report.md. Include scope, timeline, observations, competing explanations, next capture placement and a client-safe recommendation.
5. Use assets/ten-step-checklist.md to review the report. Re-run scripts/verify.py. Exchange reports with another learner and check that every conclusion can be traced to a packet or is explicitly a hypothesis.
6. Export a reproducible packet table. Record the filter, frame numbers, measurement, explanation and limitation in outputs/findings.md.

```
python3 scripts/export_evidence.py
```

Test it

The supplied `http.response.code == 500` expression matches 1 frame(s) in the specified capture. Run `scripts/verify.py` and compare the listed frame numbers. Keep your findings and exported table in `outputs/`. Explain the observed result rather than only copying a count.

http.response.code == 500					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Info
50	2.270000	192.0.2.20	192.0.2.10	HTTP	HTTP/1.1 500 Internal Server Error (text/plain)
branch-office.pcap Displayed: 1					

Lab 18 expected evidence — the packet list your filter should produce

Troubleshooting

TShark not found: install Wireshark CLI tools and add the installation folder to PATH; on Windows use the Wireshark install directory. A filter returns zero: clear other filters, use the specified capture, and check the expression is in the display toolbar. TLS remains opaque: select the matching lab-tls.keys file by absolute path, reload, and remove a key-log preference from another lab.

Try it with TShark

```
tshark -n -r data/branch-office.pcap -q -z conv,tcp
```

Challenge

Develop and explain an alternative filter.

Reflection

Which second observation point would strengthen your conclusion?

Extension (optional)

Write a second incident report from a capture in the Wireshark sample captures (wiki.wireshark.org/SampleCaptures), using the same template and checklist.

Note: Printable copy: [labs/lab-18-produce-an-evidence-led-incident-report/LAB-18-Instructions.pdf](#). Use the README in the matching [labs/lab-NN-title/](#) folder. Capture only with permission.

Next Steps

- Repeat a lab with a fresh analyst profile.
- Use the ten-step checklist on a new authorised capture.
- Preserve packet numbers, filters and limitations in every report.

Further Learning

These sources informed the course content and are recommended for extra practice. Kurose & Ross material is referenced with acknowledgement, as its terms require.

- Wireshark — Learn — <https://www.wireshark.org/learn>
- Kurose & Ross — Wireshark Labs (v9.0) — https://gaia.cs.umass.edu/kurose_ross/wireshark.php
- UMass — Wireshark lab files — <https://gaia.cs.umass.edu/wireshark-labs/>
- Cyber Defence Kit — Wireshark hands-on labs — <https://docs.cyberdefencekit.org/wireshark/hands-on-labs.html>
- LabEx — Wireshark tutorials — <https://labex.io/tutorials/category/wireshark>
- LabEx — Wireshark skill tree — <https://labex.io/classroom/skilltrees/wireshark>
- LabEx — learn-wireshark (GitHub) — <https://github.com/labex-labs/learn-wireshark>
- Wireshark.com — Learn — <https://wireshark.com/learn/>
- 101 Labs — Wireshark WCNA — <https://www.101labs.net/courses/101-labs-wireshark-wcna/>
- WPI CS3516 — Wireshark lab 1 — <https://web.cs.wpi.edu/~cs3516/b09/wireshark/wire1/>
- Wireshark sample captures — <https://wiki.wireshark.org/SampleCaptures>

Glossary

- **Capture filter** — libpcap expression limiting packets stored during capture.
- **Display filter** — Wireshark expression selecting stored packets for viewing.
- **iRTT** — Initial TCP round-trip sample from the handshake.
- **Retransmission** — Repeated TCP byte range; interpretation depends on capture completeness.
- **Zero window** — A receiver advertisement that no receive-buffer space is available.
- **TLS key log** — Per-session secrets permitting authorised decryption of the matching session.
- **SPAN** — Switch mirroring of selected traffic to a sensor port.

- **TAP** — An inline observation device supplying link traffic to a sensor.